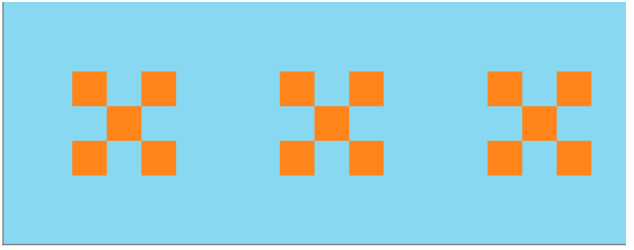
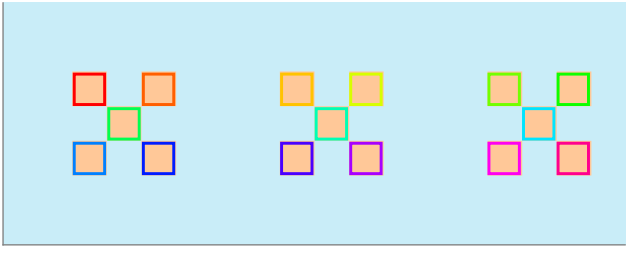
(a) Board crop: three X marks (bp35 level 3 start)



3 X marks

15 cells of colour 12 drawn on a plain plate

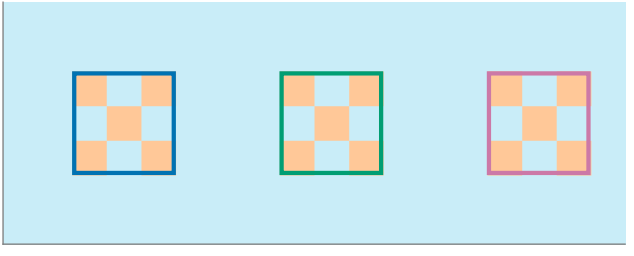
(b) 4-connected nodes, one outline each



15 nodes

every cell of an X is its own object: corners do not touch under 4-connectivity

(c) 8-connected `group`, one outline each



3 objects

each X is one 3 x 3 object with the new `group` field

(d) How often: human level starts holding such a glyph

76 starts | 108 starts without

76 of 184 level starts in 13 of 22 human replays hold a `group` of 2 or more nodes with a bounding box of at least 3 x 3 cells (73 if sparse dot lattices, fill under 0.1, are dropped). Recount with the real module.

Colours are the game's 16 indices on a fixed palette chosen for this picture; (b) and (c) are faded so the outlines read.